Gifts of the Spirit

1 Corinthians 12:1-11 (KJV)

Scripture

1 Corinthians 12:1-11

[1] Now concerning spiritual gifts, brethren, I would not have you ignorant. [2] Ye know that ye were Gentiles, carried away unto these dumb idols, even as ye were led. [3] Wherefore I give you to understand, that no man speaking by the Spirit of God calleth Jesus accursed: and that no man can say that Jesus is the Lord, but by the Holy Ghost. [4] Now there are diversities of gifts, but the same Spirit. [5] And there are differences of administrations, but the same Lord. [6] And there are diversities of operations, but it is the same God which worketh all in all. [7] But the manifestation of the Spirit is given to every man to profit withal. [8] For to one is given by the Spirit the word of wisdom; to another the word of knowledge by the same Spirit; [9] To another faith by the same Spirit; to another the gifts of healing by the same Spirit; [10] To another the working of miracles; to another prophecy; to another discerning of spirits; to another divers kinds of tongues; to another the interpretation of tongues: [11] But all these worketh that one and the selfsame Spirit, dividing to every man severally as he will.

Outline

1. The Spirit leads us to confess Jesus as Lord

No man can say that Jesus is the Lord, but by the Holy _____.

The Spirit's first work is to _____ Jesus.

Read: 1 Corinthians 12:1-3; John 16:13-14; 1 John 4:1-3

2. One Spirit, many gifts, for the common good

There are diversities of gifts, but the same _____.

Gifts are given for the common _____.

Read: 1 Corinthians 12:4-7; Romans 12:4-8; 1 Peter 4:10-11

3. The Spirit comes through the Word and Sacraments

Faith cometh by hearing, and hearing by the _____ of God.

The Holy Ghost is given through the Word and _____.

Read: Romans 10:17; 1 Corinthians 14:33; 1 Corinthians 14:40; 2 Timothy 3:16-17; Luke 16:29-31

Discussion questions

1. What do all Christians agree about spiritual gifts, according to this passage?

2. Why do Lutherans insist that the Spirit works through the Word and Sacraments?

3. What gifts has God given you, and how could you use one this week to serve others?

4. How can we hold our own convictions about the gifts while loving believers who see this differently?

This week

Be present for the Word and Sacrament this Sunday, expecting the Holy Spirit to work through them. Each day, read a portion of Scripture and pray Luther's explanation of the Third Article, thanking God that the Spirit has called you by the Gospel.